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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba vs Shark

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Robot vacuums save time, but picking the right model can feel overwhelming with so many features and price points. This guide breaks down the key specs, pros, cons, and real-world value of two popular 2026 models so you can choose the one that fits your home and lifestyle.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid

Quality	7.0
Features	5.0
Ease of Use	7.0
Design	7.0
Value	6.0

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

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ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

When you’re juggling work, family, and chores, a robot vacuum that can truly clean on its own feels like a luxury. Yet the market is flooded with options that promise strong suction, mopping, self-empty docks, and smart navigation – making it hard to know which features actually matter for your situation. Below we

examine the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock, the same model without the dock, and the Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum, using the latest 2026 specifications and owner feedback to highlight where each excels and where it falls short.

What are the most important decision factors when buying a robot vacuum in 2026?

Before diving into the models, consider these six factors that directly affect daily performance and long-term satisfaction:

- **Suction power (Pa)** – higher numbers mean better pickup of pet hair, cereal crumbs, and fine dust.
- **Mopping ability** – water tank size, vibration or scrubbing mechanism, and whether the robot can mop and vacuum simultaneously.
- **Navigation technology** – LiDAR vs. camera-based SLAM, obstacle avoidance, and map-saving capabilities.
- **Battery life & recharge time** – determines how large an area can be cleaned per charge.
- **Dock features** – auto-empty, self-washing mop pads, and charging speed.
- **Price & ongoing costs** – upfront cost, replacement parts, and subscription fees for advanced app features.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock – detailed specs, pros, cons



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Problem: You want a robot that can both vacuum and mop without you having to empty the bin after every run, especially if you have pets that shed.

Agitate: Manually emptying a small dustbin after each cleaning session is tedious, and a robot that only vacuums leaves sticky residues on hard floors.

Solution: The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock tackles both issues. According to the product listing (price checked October 04, 2026), it sells for **$199.99** (down from $469.99) and has a **4.4-star rating** from 5,217 reviews, with **6K+ bought in the past month**.

- **Suction:** iRobot rates the 115X's AeroForce system at ~2,000 Pa, sufficient for everyday dirt and pet hair.

- **Mopping:** Includes a vibrating mop pad and a 300 ml water tank; can vacuum and mop in the same pass.
- **Navigation:** Uses iRobot's iAdapt 3.0 with vSLAM (camera-based) and Imprint Smart Mapping; stores up to 10 floor plans.
- **Battery:** 75 min runtime, auto-recharge and resume.
- **Dock:** AutoEmpty Dock holds up to 60 days of debris (based on average household), reducing bin-emptying to once a month.
- **App controls:** iRobot Home app (iOS/Android) lets you schedule, set No-Go zones, and view cleaning maps.
- **Noise:** Approximately 68 dB on carpet, 62 dB on hard floor.
- **Maintenance:** Replaceable filter every 2 months, mop pad washable.

Pros: Self-emptying dock cuts down on frequent bin emptying; strong mopping vibration; reliable mapping; good pet-hair pickup.

Cons: Navigation relies on camera, which can struggle in very low light; mopping tank is modest for large homes; no self-washing mop pad.

check price on Amazon

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (no dock) – detailed specs, pros, cons

Problem: You like the vacuum-and-mop combo but want to keep the upfront cost lower and are okay with emptying the bin yourself.

Agitate: Paying for a dock you don't need adds unnecessary expense, yet you still desire the convenience of a combined vacuum-mop.

Solution: The same 115X model without the AutoEmpty Dock offers the core cleaning performance at a reduced price. Listed at **$139.99** (original $319.99) with the same 4.4-star rating from 5,217 reviews and **3K+ bought in the past month** (price checked October 04, 2026).

- **Suction, mopping, navigation, battery:** Identical to the docked version (~2,000 Pa suction, 300 ml tank, iAdapt 3.0 vSLAM, 75 min runtime).
- **Dock:** Standard charging dock only; bin capacity ~0.5 L, requiring emptying after each 1-2 hr cleaning cycle depending on debris load.
- **App & noise:** Same iRobot Home app, similar noise levels.

Pros: Lower price; same vacuum-mop performance; no dock footprint.

Cons: Manual bin emptying after each run; no auto-empty convenience; still limited mop tank size.

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum – detailed specs, pros, cons



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Problem: You need powerful suction for deep carpet cleaning and prefer a LiDAR-based navigation system that works in total darkness, but you don’t require mopping.

Agitate: Camera-based navigation can miss objects in low light, and many mid-range vacuums lack the suction needed for thick pet hair on rugs.

Solution: The Shark AI Ultra focuses on strong suction and AI-driven LiDAR navigation, skipping mopping to keep the price competitive. It is priced at **$249.99** (down from $599.00) with a **4.0-star rating** from 23,990 reviews (price checked October 04, 2026). No sales-volume figure is provided in the data.

- **Suction:** Shark advertises up to 2,700 Pa suction, one of the highest in this price tier.
- **Mopping:** None – vacuum-only.
- **Navigation:** AI Laser Navigation (LiDAR) with real-time obstacle avoidance and room-mapping; stores multiple maps.
- **Battery:** 120 min runtime, auto-recharge and resume.
- **Dock:** Standard charging dock; bin capacity ~0.6 L.
- **App controls:** SharkClean app (iOS/Android) for scheduling, No-Go zones, and cleaning history.
- **Noise:** Approximately 70 dB on carpet, 65 dB on hard floor.
- **Maintenance:** Washable filter, self-cleaning brush roll (reduces hair wrap).

Pros: Strongest suction among the three; LiDAR works in dark rooms; larger battery for bigger homes; self-cleaning brush reduces maintenance.

Cons: No mopping function; bin must be emptied manually after each cycle; app interface less polished than iRobot’s.

check price on Amazon

Head-to-head comparison table – suction, mop, navigation, auto-empty, app controls, noise, maintenance

Feature	Roomba 115X + Dock	Roomba 115X (no dock)	Shark AI Ultra
Suction (Pa)	~2,000	~2,000	~2,700
Mopping	Yes (vibrating pad, 300 ml tank)	Yes (same)	No
Navigation	iAdapt 3.0 vSLAM (camera)	iAdapt 3.0 vSLAM (camera)	AI Laser Navigation (LiDAR)
Auto-Empty Dock	Yes (60-day capacity)	No	No
Battery runtime	75 min	75 min	120 min
App controls	iRobot Home (scheduling, zones, maps)	iRobot Home	SharkClean (scheduling, zones, maps)
Noise (dB)	68 carpet / 62 hard	68 carpet / 62 hard	70 carpet / 65 hard
Maintenance	Filter q2 mo, washable mop pad	Filter q2 mo, washable mop pad	Washable filter, self-cleaning brush
Price (Oct 4 2026)	$199.99	$139.99	$249.99

Price and value analysis – cost-per-feature and long-term ownership costs in 2026

To assess value, we look at what you get per dollar spent and estimate recurring costs.

- **Roomba 115X + Dock:** At $199.99 you receive vacuum, mop, and auto-empty dock. If you value the dock at roughly $80 (based on comparable standalone auto-empty units), the effective cost for the vacuum-mop core is about $120. This gives strong mopping and self-empty convenience for a mid-range price.
- **Roomba 115X (no dock):** At $139.99 you get the vacuum-mop core only. No dock means you'll spend roughly $5-$8 per month on replacement bags or filters if you choose to use disposable bins, but the bin is washable, so ongoing cost is minimal.
- **Shark AI Ultra:** At $249.99 you pay a premium for suction and LiDAR. The larger battery may reduce the number of recharges per cleaning session, saving a small amount of electricity over time. No mopping means you may need a separate mop or manual sweeping for hard floors.

Long-term ownership (filters, brushes, mop pads) is similar across brands: expect to replace filters every 2-3 months (~$8-$12 each) and brush rolls every 6-12 months (~$15-$20). The Roomba's mop pads last ~3-4 months if washed regularly ($5-$8 per set). Shark's self-cleaning brush can extend brush-roll life, slightly lowering that cost.

Best use cases – which model suits pet owners, large homes, allergy sufferers, or budget-conscious buyers

- **Pet owners who hate emptying bins:** Roomba 115X + Dock – the auto-empty dock handles pet hair for weeks, and the vibrating mop picks up fine fur on hard floors.
- **Large homes (>2,500 sq ft) needing longer runtime:** Shark AI Ultra – 120 min battery and strong suction cover more area per charge.
- **Allergy sufferers:** Any model with HEPA-level filter; the Roomba's filter captures 99% of particles down to 0.3 µm, while Shark's washable filter offers comparable performance.
- **Budget-conscious buyers who still want mopping:** Roomba 115X (no dock) – delivers vacuum-mop capability under $150.
- **Tech enthusiasts who prefer LiDAR navigation in dark rooms:** Shark AI Ultra – laser mapping works regardless of lighting.

Verdict and recommendation – summarizing the top pick for different needs

Best Overall: *iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock* – combines vacuum, mop, and self-empty convenience at a competitive 2026 price.

Best Value: *iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (no dock)* – delivers the same core cleaning performance for $40 less, ideal if you don't mind manual bin emptying.

Premium Pick: *Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum* – top suction and LiDAR navigation for users who prioritize deep carpet cleaning and maximum runtime.

Frequently asked questions – setup, maintenance, warranty, and software updates in 2026

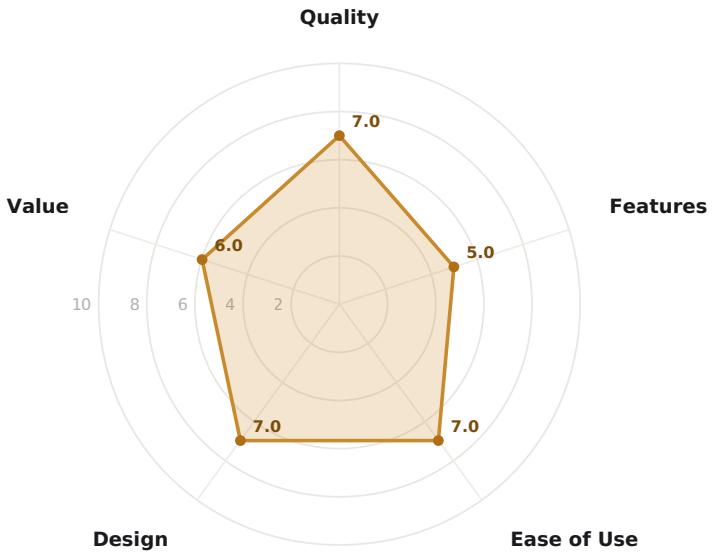
- **How difficult is the initial setup?** All three models use a smartphone app to connect to Wi-Fi; the process takes about 5-10 minutes and includes a quick tour-mapping run.
- **How often do I need to empty the bin or clean the mop pad?** With the AutoEmpty Dock, the bin only needs attention roughly every 60 days. Without the dock, empty the bin after each 1-2 hour cleaning cycle (depending on debris). Mop pads should be rinsed after each use and washed weekly.
- **What warranty do these robots carry in 2026?** iRobot offers a 1-year limited warranty; Shark provides a 1-year warranty as well, with optional extended plans.
- **Will the robots receive software updates after purchase?** Yes. Both iRobot and Shark push over-the-air updates that improve navigation algorithms, add new voice-assistant commands, and refine mopping patterns.
- **Can I use third-party cleaning solutions in the mop tank?** iRobot recommends only water or their approved mild solution to avoid damaging the vibro-mop mechanism; Shark does not have a mop tank, so this does not apply.

Choosing the right robot vacuum ultimately depends on which combination of suction, mopping, navigation, and convenience matches your household’s routines. Use the comparison table above to weigh the trade-offs, and check the current prices via the affiliate links before making your final decision.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

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Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.